

PM AND COUNCIL OF MINISTERS

RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE: ARTICLES 74 → PRIME MINISTER APPOINTMENT AND → COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND → COLLECTIVE, INDIVIDUAL AND LEGAL → PRIME MINISTER'S FIVE RELATIONSHIP → CABINET ECOSYSTEM: COMMITTEES, SECRETARIAT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

STAGE 00 RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE: ARTICLES 74, 75, 77 AND 78

RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE ARTICLES 74, 75, 77 AND 78 FORMAL HEAD REAL EXECUTIVE

PRESIDENT PRIME MINISTER + COUNCIL OF MINISTERS ARTICLE 74 AID AND ADVICE

ARTICLE 75 APPOINTMENT, TENURE, RESPONSIBILITY, SIX-MONTH RULE, MINISTRY CAP

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- FORMAL HEAD REAL EXECUTIVE
- President Prime Minister + Council of Ministers

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ARTICLE 74: aid and advice
- ARTICLE 75 → appointment, tenure, responsibility, six-month rule, ministry cap

CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 77 → Union business in President's name + Rules of Business
- ARTICLE 78 → PM informs President and submits matters for reconsideration

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CORE RESULT executive power is politically answerable to Lok Sabha through responsible government.
- FORMAL HEAD REAL EXECUTIVE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Articles 74 and 75 create a dual executive in which the President is formal head while the Prime Minister-led ministry exercises responsible political power.

STAGE 01 PRIME MINISTER APPOINTMENT AND GOVERNMENT FORMATION

PRIME MINISTER APPOINTMENT AND GOVERNMENT FORMATION

CLEAR MAJORITY PRESIDENT APPOINTS RECOGNISED MAJORITY LEADER

MINISTERS ON PM ADVICE

HUNG LOK SABHA OBJECTIVE SUPPORT EVIDENCE

APPOINT PERSON MOST LIKELY TO COMMAND CONFIDENCE

PROMPT FLOOR TEST

MINISTRY SURVIVES OR RESIGNS

CLEAR MAJORITY

President appoints recognised majority leader → ministers on PM advice

HUNG LOK SABHA objective support evidence → appoint person most likely to command confidence

prompt floor test → ministry survives or resigns

ELIGIBILITY minister may be non-member for six consecutive months disqualified person cannot use six-month rule

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CLEAR MAJORITY
- President appoints recognised majority leader → ministers on PM advice

POWER / PROCEDURE

- HUNG LOK SABHA objective support evidence → appoint person most likely to command confidence
- prompt floor test → ministry survives or resigns

CHECK / LIMIT

- ELIGIBILITY minister may be non-member for six consecutive months disqualified person cannot use six-month rule to evade the Constitution
- TENURE no fixed PM term; office depends on Lok Sabha confidence and constitutional continuity.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CLEAR MAJORITY
- President appoints recognised majority leader → ministers on PM advice

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Charan Singh was appointed Prime Minister in 1979 in a fluid majority situation but resigned without facing the confidence vote after promised support was withdrawn.

STAGE 02 COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND THE 91ST AMENDMENT

COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND THE 91ST AMENDMENT

COUNCIL OF MINISTERS CABINET LARGER CONSTITUTIONAL BODY INNER DECISION-MAKING

CABINET + MINISTERS OF STATE + DEPUTIES SENIOR PORTFOLIOS

ARTICLE 74 ARTICLE 352 EXPRESSLY NAMES CABINET

CABINET MINISTER

MINISTER OF STATE (INDEPENDENT CHARGE)

DEPUTY MINISTER LABELS SUCH AS PARLIAMENTARY SECRETARY DO NOT

91ST AMENDMENT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

COUNCIL OF MINISTERS CABINET larger constitutional body inner decision-making core

Cabinet + Ministers of State + deputies senior portfolios and collective direction

Article 74 Article 352 expressly names Cabinet

POWER / PROCEDURE

Cabinet Minister

Minister of State (independent charge / attached)

Deputy Minister labels such as parliamentary secretary do not automatically create Cabinet rank

CHECK / LIMIT

91ST AMENDMENT

Union ministry <= 15% of Lok Sabha strength

Tenth Schedule defector disqualified from ministerial appointment for the stated period.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Cabinet Minister

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- COUNCIL OF MINISTERS CABINET larger constitutional body inner decision-making core
- Cabinet + Ministers of State + deputies senior portfolios and collective direction
- Article 74 Article 352 expressly names Cabinet

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Cabinet Minister
- Minister of State (independent charge / attached)
- Deputy Minister labels such as parliamentary secretary do not automatically create Cabinet rank

CHECK / LIMIT

- 91ST AMENDMENT
- Union ministry <= 15% of Lok Sabha strength
- Tenth Schedule defector disqualified from ministerial appointment for the stated period.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Cabinet Minister

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cabinet is constitutionally narrower than the Council of Ministers and now appears expressly in Article 352, although the original text did not name it.

STAGE 03 COLLECTIVE, INDIVIDUAL AND LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

COLLECTIVE, INDIVIDUAL AND LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

ARTICLE 75(3) ONE POLITICAL UNIT

CABINET SOLIDARITY

LOK SABHA CONFIDENCE LOSS OF CONFIDENCE

WHOLE MINISTRY RESIGNS

ARTICLE 75(2) MINISTER HOLDS OFFICE DURING PRESIDENT'S PLEASURE, EXERCISED

PM MAY REQUIRE RESIGNATION OR ADVISE DISMISSAL

LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- COLLECTIVE: ARTICLE 75(3) one political unit → Cabinet solidarity → Lok Sabha confidence loss of confidence → whole ministry resigns
- INDIVIDUAL: ARTICLE 75(2) minister holds office during President's pleasure, exercised within PM-led government

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PM may require resignation or advise dismissal
- LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

CHECK / LIMIT

- India lacks the British rule requiring a ministerial countersignature on every formal act
- Article 77 authentication protects authorised orders from challenge on signature form alone

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ACCOUNTABILITY CHAIN decision → shared defence → questions/committee/audit → confidence sanction.
- COLLECTIVE: ARTICLE 75(3) one political unit → Cabinet solidarity → Lok Sabha confidence loss of confidence → whole ministry resigns

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: India does not require a ministerial countersignature on every formal act of the President as a universal condition of validity.

STAGE 04 PRIME MINISTER'S FIVE RELATIONSHIP ARENAS

PRIME MINISTER'S FIVE RELATIONSHIP ARENAS

CABINET SELECTS TEAM, ALLOCATES PORTFOLIOS, SETS AGENDA, COORDINATES AND

PRESIDENT PRINCIPAL ADVISER + ARTICLE 78 INFORMATION BRIDGE +

PARLIAMENT GOVERNMENT LEADER, CONFIDENCE MANAGER, POLICY STATEMENT AND LEGISLATIVE

COALITION LEADERSHIP DEPENDS ON MAJORITY, ALLIANCE AGREEMENTS, INTERNAL BARGAINING

NATIONAL INTERGOVERNMENTAL LEADERSHIP, CRISIS COORDINATION AND NATIONAL POLICY DIRECTION.

COUNCIL / CABINET selects team, allocates portfolios, sets agenda, coordinates and can seek resignation

PRESIDENT principal adviser + Article 78 information bridge + reconsideration channel

PARLIAMENT government leader, confidence manager, policy statement and legislative programme

PARTY / COALITION leadership depends on majority, alliance agreements, internal bargaining and legitimacy

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- COUNCIL / CABINET selects team, allocates portfolios, sets agenda, coordinates and can seek resignation
- PRESIDENT principal adviser + Article 78 information bridge + reconsideration channel

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PARLIAMENT government leader, confidence manager, policy statement and legislative programme
- PARTY / COALITION leadership depends on majority, alliance agreements, internal bargaining and legitimacy

CHECK / LIMIT

- FEDERAL / NATIONAL intergovernmental leadership, crisis coordination and national policy direction.
- COUNCIL / CABINET selects team, allocates portfolios, sets agenda, coordinates and can seek resignation

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- PRESIDENT principal adviser + Article 78 information bridge + reconsideration channel
- PARLIAMENT government leader, confidence manager, policy statement and legislative programme

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The PM leads the government in Parliament and must retain Lok Sabha confidence.

STAGE 05 CABINET ECOSYSTEM: COMMITTEES, SECRETARIAT AND PMO

CABINET ECOSYSTEM

COMMITTEES, SECRETARIAT AND PMO

ARTICLE 77(3) RULES

ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS

WHO HANDLES A SUBJECT

TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS

HOW IMPORTANT BUSINESS MOVES AND IS DECIDED

CABINET COMMITTEES STANDING

ARTICLE 77(3) RULES

Allocation of Business → who handles a subject

Transaction of Business → how important business moves and is decided

CABINET COMMITTEES standing / ad hoc

reduce workload and coordinate cross-ministry choices current number, membership and chairs depend on dated notification

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 77(3) RULES
- Allocation of Business → who handles a subject

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Transaction of Business → how important business moves and is decided
- CABINET COMMITTEES standing / ad hoc

CHECK / LIMIT

- reduce workload and coordinate cross-ministry choices current number, membership and chairs depend on dated notification
- CABINET SECRETARIAT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Cabinet support + records + inter-ministerial coordination + crisis management
- PMO staff support, monitoring and policy coordination; not a constitutional substitute for ministries.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cabinet Committees combine ministerial authority with specialised coordination, unlike Committees of Secretaries which remain administrative forums.

STAGE 06 PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL, CONFIDENCE AND ANTI-DEFECTION

PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL, CONFIDENCE AND ANTI-DEFECTION

QUESTION HOUR

ZERO HOUR

COMMITTEE EVIDENCE

FINANCIAL CONTROL

POLITICAL SANCTION NO-CONFIDENCE MOTION IN LOK SABHA

COLLECTIVE RESIGNATION IF CARRIED

ANTI-DEFECTION INTERFACE WHIP SUPPORTS GOVERNMENT STABILITY BUT CAN COMPRESS

Question Hour → Zero Hour → discussions → committee evidence

FINANCIAL CONTROL

Budget → grants → appropriation → CAG → PAC / DRSC

POLITICAL SANCTION no-confidence motion in Lok Sabha → collective resignation if carried

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Question Hour → Zero Hour → discussions → committee evidence
- FINANCIAL CONTROL

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Budget → grants → appropriation → CAG → PAC / DRSC
- POLITICAL SANCTION no-confidence motion in Lok Sabha → collective resignation if carried

CHECK / LIMIT

- ANTI-DEFECTION INTERFACE whip supports government stability but can compress independent legislative judgment
- CONSTRUCTIVE NO-CONFIDENCE reform proposal for stability; not current constitutional law in India.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Question Hour → Zero Hour → discussions → committee evidence
- FINANCIAL CONTROL

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Effective accountability therefore depends on information, committee time and political incentives, not merely formal powers.

STAGE 07 COALITION, MINORITY, CARETAKER AND PRIME-MINISTERIAL GOVERNMENT

COALITION, MINORITY, CARETAKER AND PRIME-MINISTERIAL GOVERNMENT

MAJORITY GOVERNMENT

STRONGER AGENDA CONTROL, RISK OF EXECUTIVE DOMINANCE

BARGAINING AND INCLUSION, RISK OF FRAGMENTED RESPONSIBILITY

ISSUE-BASED SUPPORT AND GREATER PARLIAMENTARY NEGOTIATION

CONTINUITY WITH SELF-RESTRAINT; NO SEPARATE CONSTITUTIONAL ARTICLE

CABINET GOVERNMENT PRIME-MINISTERIAL GOVERNMENT COLLECTIVE DELIBERATION CENTRAL AGENDA AND

ELECTORAL LEADERSHIP

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- MAJORITY GOVERNMENT → stronger agenda control, risk of executive dominance
- COALITION → bargaining and inclusion, risk of fragmented responsibility

POWER / PROCEDURE

- MINORITY → issue-based support and greater parliamentary negotiation
- CARETAKER → continuity with self-restraint; no separate constitutional article

CHECK / LIMIT

- CABINET GOVERNMENT PRIME-MINISTERIAL GOVERNMENT collective deliberation central agenda and appointment influence ministerial expertise PMO / communication / electoral
- QUALIFIED VERDICT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- PM predominance varies with party control, coalition arithmetic, institutions and public legitimacy.
- MAJORITY GOVERNMENT → stronger agenda control, risk of executive dominance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Election Commission's Model Code of Conduct may constrain conduct during elections, but it is not a complete constitutional code for every caretaker situation.

STAGE 08 CASES, CONVENTIONS, REFORMS AND THE ANSWER SPINE

CASES, CONVENTIONS, REFORMS AND THE ANSWER SPINE

CONSTITUTIONAL CONTROLS

SHAMSHER SINGH (1974)

RESPONSIBLE ADVICE

S.R. CHAUDHURI (2001)

SIX-MONTH RULE CANNOT BE SERIALLY ABUSED

TENTH SCHEDULE + 91ST AMENDMENT

CONSTITUTIONAL CONTROLS

Shamsher Singh (1974) → responsible advice

S.R. Chaudhuri (2001) → six-month rule cannot be serially abused

Tenth Schedule + 91st Amendment → stability and anti-defection constraints

PRELIMS FIREWALL

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CONSTITUTIONAL CONTROLS
- Shamsher Singh (1974) → responsible advice
- S.R. Chaudhuri (2001) → six-month rule cannot be serially abused

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Tenth Schedule + 91st Amendment → stability and anti-defection constraints
- PRELIMS FIREWALL
- Council != Cabinet

CHECK / LIMIT

- Article 88 gives participation, not a vote without membership ministry cap uses Lok Sabha strength
- Cabinet Committee composition is current-sensitive
- REFORM publish reasons and outcomes, strengthen committees, limit whip, protect Cabinet deliberation

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- MAINS SPINE text → formation → responsibility → coordination institutions → accountability
- political variation → balanced strong-executive / responsible-government verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The guiding principle is coordination without erasing responsibility: PM leadership should connect institutions, not make ministers and Parliament redundant.

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

A1. CONSTITUTIONAL TEXT VERSUS POLITICAL OPERATING SYSTEM

A2. CASE-LAW AND INSTITUTIONAL TIMELINE

A3. ANALYTICAL LABELS WITH CAUTION

A4. COALITION-ERA VARIATION

A5. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

A6. CONCISE SOURCE AND CURRENT-CONTROL NOTE

[ANALYSIS] THE CONSTITUTION FIXES RESPONSIBILITY BUT NOT A CONSTANT

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- A1. Constitutional text versus political operating system
- A2. Case-law and institutional timeline
- A3. Analytical labels with caution
- A4. Coalition-era variation

ADVANCED LIMIT

- A5. Answer architecture
- A6. Concise source and current-control note
- [ANALYSIS] The Constitution fixes responsibility but not a constant distribution of influence inside the executive.
- [ANALYSIS] A "core executive" approach maps PM, Cabinet, PMO, Cabinet Secretariat, finance, security and senior bureaucracy as a

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- network rather than assuming one permanent centre.
- [LIMIT] Network analysis cannot displace the legal rule that competent authorities must act through Constitution, statute and business rules.
- [ANALYSIS] The office is constitutionally constant but politically elastic.
- [ANALYSIS] Coalition constraints may improve consultation and federal voice while also producing veto points and blurred accountability.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.